INTRODUCTORY SOMMELIER COURSE

PRACTICE EXAMINATION

Introductory Sommelier Course Practice Examination

LAST NAME: _____

FIRST NAME: _____

1) The Pays Nantais, Touraine, and Anjou-Saumur regions are all located in _____.
a. The Loire Valley
b. Champagne
c. Burgundy
d. The Rhône Valley

2) _____ is a grape species.
a. Cabernet Sauvignon
b. Vitis vinifera
c. Brettanomyces
d. Quercus suber

3) What is the predominant grape variety of the wine pictured below?
a. Pinot Noir
b. Grenache Noir
c. Cabernet Sauvignon
d. Malbec

4) The _____ Mountains create a rain shadow effect for the vineyards of the Mendoza IG.
a. Sierra Cantabria
b. Santa Cruz
c. Andes
d. Coastal

5) The _____ label term indicates a traditional, theoretically superior vineyard area within a DOC or DOCG.
a. Frizzante
b. Dolce
c. Secco
d. Classico

6) Cooler climates generally produce wines with _____.
a. Elevated acidity
b. Higher residual sugar
c. Elevated alcohol
d. Lower tannins

7) Winemakers wanting increased butter flavor and creamier texture in white wines promote __.
a. Carbonic maceration
b. Acidification
c. Malolactic fermentation
d. Chaptalization

8) The primary grape variety of the Rheingau is _____.
a. Grüner Veltliner
b. Riesling
c. Spätburgunder
d. Müller-Thurgau

9) Which of the following grape varieties produces wine with intense aromas of bell pepper and blackcurrant?
a. Syrah
b. Nebbiolo
c. Cabernet Sauvignon
d. Merlot

10) Amongst the following California AVAs, _____ is most renowned for producing sparkling wine.
a. Calistoga
b. Dry Creek
c. Paso Robles
d. Anderson Valley

11) A wine labeled SGN (or Sélection de Grains Nobles) is a _____ wine.
a. Sweet
b Sparking
c. Fortified
d. Dry Red

12) Carmenère is most commonly associated with wine produced in _____.
a. Chile
b. United States
c. New Zealand
d. South Africa

13) A _____ -style beer is produced via top-fermenting yeasts in warmer temperatures.
a. Pilsner
b Pale Ale
c. Bock
d. Oktoberfest

14) Which of the following regions has the coolest climate?
a. Châteauneuf-du-Pape
b. Barossa Valley
c. Mosel
d. Napa Valley

15) Bottles, decanters, and corks should always be placed _____.
a. On an underliner on the guests' table
b. At a side station away from the guest
c. On an underliner at a side station away from the guest
d. Directly on the guests' table without an underliner

16) The aromas of TCA (or "corked wine") are generally described as smelling like _____.
a. Spoiled egg and/or struck matchstick
b. Moldy cardboard and/or must
c. Band-Aid and/or barnyard
d. Vinegar and/or nail polish remover

17) The _____ DOP in Portugal is most associated with the _____ grape variety.
a. Vinho Verde / Alvarinho
b. Maule / Tempranillo
c. Rueda / Verdejo
d. Mendoza / Garnacha

18) Château Cheval Blanc is classified as a _____ per the Saint-Émilion Classification of 2012.

a. Vin Ordinaire
b. Gran Reserva
c. Premier Grand Cru Classé 'A'
d. Kabinett

19) In which century did Australia establish itself as a major wine exporter?

a. 17th
b. 18th
c. 19th
d. 20th

20) Alcoholic fermentation requires the interaction of _____ and _____.

a. Oak barrels / Dead yeast cells
b. Water / Alcoholic spirit
c. Sugar / Yeast
d Carbon dioxide / Oxygen

21) Which of the following spirits can be distilled from corn, potatoes, wheat, and/or rice?

a. Vodka
b. Rum
c. Brandy
d. Tequila

22) Which of the following countries features the Southern Alps mountain range?

a. Chile
b. South Africa
c. New Zealand
d. Argentina

23) _____ refers to a white Champagne made from Pinot Noir and/or Meunier.

a. Demi-sec
b. Monopole
c. Tête du Cuvée
d. Blanc de Noirs

24) Which of the following aspects of wine will make meats and cheeses feel less rich and fatty?

a. Moderately high tannin
b. Bone dry
c. Low acid
d. Ripe fruit

25) The primary color (or colors) of Wachau DAC wine is/are _____.
a. White
b. White and Rosé
c. Rosé and Red
d. Red

26) The closure pictured below is used for a _____ wine produced via the _____ method.
a. Fortified / Arrested Fermentation
b. Sparkling / Traditional
c. Dessert / Carbonation
d. Sparkling / Tank

27) _____ on a bottle of Rioja DOCa indicates the longest amount of aging before release.
a. Denominación de Origen Calificada
b. Vino
c. Gran Reserva
d. Tinto

28) Schist, marl, and silt are types of _____.
a. Vine clones
b. Trellising
c. Fertilizer
d. Soil

29) Relative to the general harvest timing in Bordeaux, grapes used in the production of Sauternes AOP are picked _____.

a. Early
b. At the same time
c. Late
d. When frozen

30) _____ is located in South Africa.

a. Marlborough
b. Stellenbosch
c. Margaret River
d. Russian River Valley

31) Which of the following descriptions most indicates the extended barrel and bottle aging of a white wine?

a. Golden color
b. Primary, fresh fruit flavors
c. Short finish
d. High acid

32) The Morgon, Moulin-à-Vent, and Brouilly AOPs are all located in _____ .

a. Chablis
b. Côte d'Or
c. Beaujolais
d. Côte Chalonnaise

33) The climate of the Columbia Valley AVA can best be categorized as _____.

a. Subtropical
b. Mediterranean
c. Maritime
d. Continental

34) Which of the following is NEVER a consideration in defining an AOP?

a. Geographic boundaries
b. Production methods
c. Price per bottle
d. Grape variety

35) The label term _____ indicates that a sake is unpasteurized.

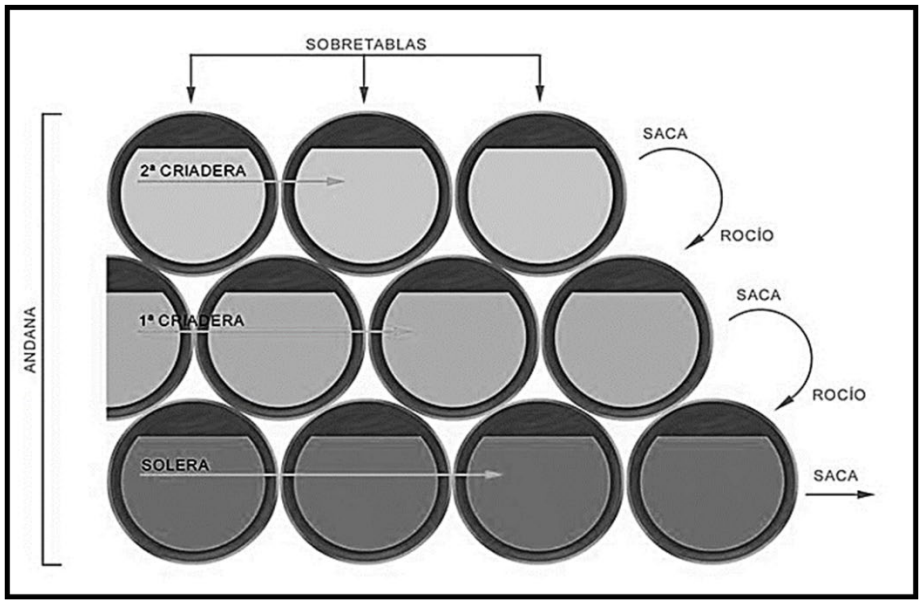
a. Daiginjo
b. Nigori
c. Ginjo
d. Namazake

36) Alto Adige is most known for producing _____ wines.
a. Sweet, still red
b Dry, still white
c Sweet, sparkling white
d. Fortified, aromatized red

37) Which of the following AOPs features the greatest percentage of steep hillside vineyards?
a. Côte-Rôtie
b. Pauillac
c. Puligny-Montrachet
d. Champagne

38) Which of the following wines is a classic pairing with fresh goat cheese?
a. Barolo
b. 10-Year Tawny Port
c. Sancerre
d. Napa Valley Cabernet Sauvignon

39) To which fortified wine does the diagram illustrating Running the Scales apply?
a. Port
b. Muscat de Beaumes-de-Venise
c. Madeira
d. Sherry



40) _____ is most commonly associated with white wine production in Argentina.
a. Albariño
b. Torrontés
c. Verdejo
d. Carricante

41) _____ is the removal of unwanted items and damaged fruit from desired grape bunches arriving at the winery after picking.

a. Maceration
b. Fermentation
c. Crushing
d. Sorting

42) What are the primary grape varieties grown in the Priorat DOCa?

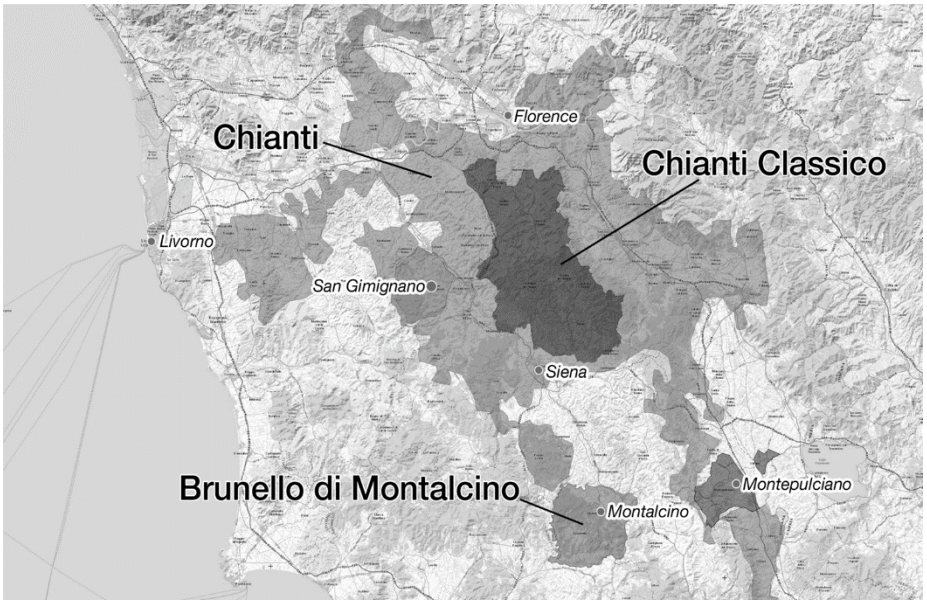
a. Garnacha / Cariñena
b. Torrontés / Verdejo
c. Tempranillo / Albariño
d. Cabernet Sauvignon / Tempranillo

43) What is the minimum number of months of lees aging required to produce Champagne AOP?

a. 6
b. 9
c. 12
d. 36

44) What region is depicted in the map below?

a. Veneto
b. Tuscany
c. Sicily
d. Piedmont



45) Tokaji Aszú is a sweet, white wine from which country?
a. Italy
b. United States
c. Canada
d. Hungary

46) The base material in the production of rum is _____.
a. Grain
b. Grapes
c. Blue Agave
d. Sugarcane

47) Riesling generally produces wines with elevated _____.
a. Alcohol
b. Color
c. Acidity
d. Tannins

48) _____ is the local name for the most renowned soil of the Coonawarra GI of Australia.
a. Terra Rossa
b. Galets
c. Silex
d. Galestro

49) What is the primary grape variety used to produce Chinon AOP?
a. Cabernet Franc
b. Pinot Noir
c. Syrah
d. Gamay Noir

50) Quinta is best defined as _____.
a. Vintage
b. Variety
c. Vineyard
d. Country

51) At 10 years of age, which of the following red wines would most likely require decanting due to sediment?
a. Beaujolais-Villages (based on Gamay Noir)
b. Rioja (based on Tempranillo)
c. Chianti (based on Sangiovese)
d. Hermitage (based on Syrah)

52) What color is Vintage Port when bottled?
a. White
b. Pink
c. Purple
d. Brown

53) The Maipo Valley DO is located in _____.
a. Chile
b. Spain
c. Argentina
d. Portugal

54) The climate of the Champagne AOP can best be categorized as _____.
a. Subtropical
b. Mediterranean
c. Maritime
d. Continental

55) Which of the following physical features most affects the vineyards of Pauillac AOP in Bordeaux?
a. Vosges Mountains
b. Gironde Estuary
c. Rhône River
d. Limousin Forest

56) Which of the following Italian terms refers to the fog that rolls off the Alps into Piedmont vineyards?
a. Riserva
b. Nebbia
c. Spumante
d. Appassimento

57) The Kamptal and Kremstal regions are located in _____.
a. Germany
b. France
c. Italy
d. Austria

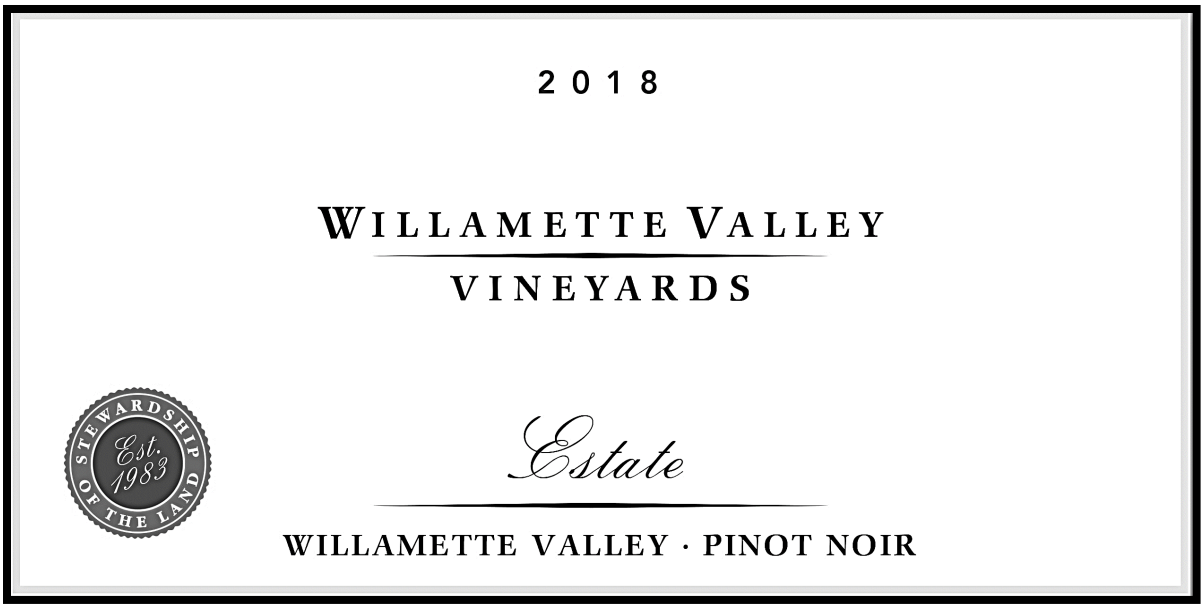
58) Alcohol in wine is perceived as _____ in the mouth, throat, and chest.
a. Astringency
b. Tartness
c. Fruitiness
d. Heat

59) Which of the following spirits is most likely to age in oak barrels?
a. Gin
b. Cognac
c. Tequila
d. Vodka

60) _____ is a prominent sub-region of the Hawke's Bay GI in New Zealand.
a. Gimblett Gravels
b. McLaren Vale
c. Marlborough
d. Paarl

61) The predominant soil type found in the Mosel is _____.
a. Volcanic basalt
b. Slate
c. Gravel
d. Limestone / Chalk

62) What is the most likely grape variety used to produce the wine with the below label?
a. Pinot Noir
b. Zinfandel
c. Cabernet Sauvignon
d. Merlot



63) Le Musigny is classified as a _____ .
a. Village
b. First Growth
c. Vin de Table
d. Grand Cru

64) _____ generally produces wine with aromas of ripe yellow apple and pineapple, butter, and baking spice.
a. Marlborough Sauvignon Blanc
b. Alsace Gewurztraminer
c. Friuli Pinot Grigio
d. Sonoma Valley Chardonnay

65) The majority of Alsace Grand Cru AOP wines are made from _____.
a. A blend of white grape varieties
b. A single white grape variety
c. A blend of red wine grape varieties
d. A single red grape variety

66) The Rías Baixas DO produces mostly _____ wines.
a. Sweet, still red
b. Dry, still white
c. Sweet, sparkling white
d. Fortified, aromatized red

67) Sugar in food will make wine taste more _____.
a. Tart and/or Bitter
b. Fruity
c. Aged
d. Oaky

68) Which of the following people is largely considered the "Father of Modern Napa Valley"?
a. Robert Mondavi
b. Baron Le Roy
c. Piero Antinori
d. David Lett

69) Which of the following grape varieties produces wine in both Stellenbosch WO and Vouvray AOP?

a. Riesling
b. Pinot Gris
c. Chenin Blanc
d. Chardonnay

70) Which of the following regions is most likely to feature the gravel topsoil pictured below?

a. Douro
b. Pauillac
c. Mosel
d. Priorat

Introductory Sommelier Course Practice Examination

ANSWER KEY

1.	A	25.	A	49.	A
2.	B	26.	B	50.	C
3.	B	27.	C	51.	D
4.	C	28.	D	52.	C
5.	D	29.	C	53.	A
6.	A	30.	B	54.	D
7.	C	31.	A	55.	B
8.	B	32.	C	56.	B
9.	C	33.	D	57.	D
10.	D	34.	C	58.	D
11.	A	35.	D	59.	B
12.	A	36.	B	60.	A
13.	B	37.	A	61.	B
14.	C	38.	C	62.	A
15.	A	39.	D	63.	D
16.	B	40.	B	64.	D
17.	A	41.	D	65.	B
18.	C	42.	A	66.	B
19.	D	43.	C	67.	A
20.	C	44.	B	68.	A
21.	A	45.	D	69.	C
22.	C	46.	D	70.	B
23.	D	47.	C		
24.	A	48.	A		

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